Coordinates

Exam code: 0607

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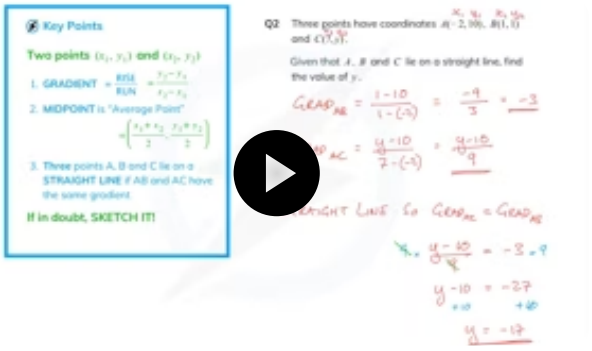

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2D coordinates

What is the Cartesian plane?

- The **Cartesian plane** is a **two-dimensional** grid that has
  - a **horizontal** scale, called the ***x*-axis**
  - a **vertical** scale, called the ***y*-axis**
- The two axes **meet** at the **origin**
  - where ***x* and *y* are both 0**

What are coordinates?

- **Coordinates** are a **pair** of **numbers**, x and y, that describe the **location** of a **point** on the grid
  - They are written in **brackets** as **(x, y)**
  - The point is
    - ***x* units** on the **horizontal** scale
    - ***y* units** on the **vertical** scale
- The **origin** is **(0, 0)**
  - **Positive** values of ***x*** are to the **right** of the origin
    - **Negative** values are to the **left**
  - **Positive** values of ***y*** are **above** the origin
    - **Negative** values are **below**
- For example, from the origin:
  - (2, 5) is the point 2 units to the **right** and 5 units **up**
  - (-1, -4) is the point 1 unit to the **left** and 4 units **down**

Help me understand

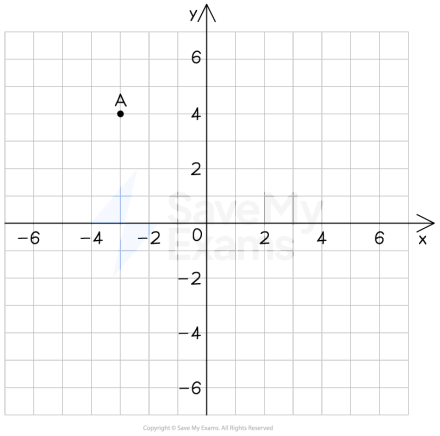
Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Check the scale on the coordinate grid! 1 square might not represent 1 unit.

Worked Example

(a) Write down the coordinates of the point *A* shown on the axes below.



Answer:

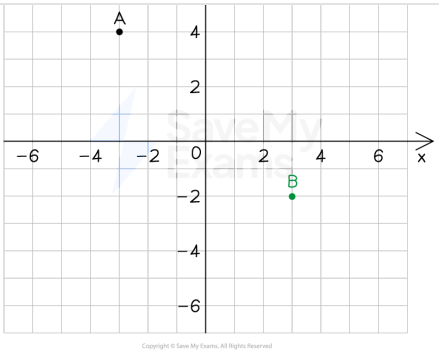
A is 3 units to left, so *x* is −3
A is 4 units up, so *y* is 4
Give your answer in brackets

(−3, 4)

(b) Mark the point *B* with coordinates (3,- 2) on the same set of axes.

Answer:

Start at the origin
Count 3 units right and two units down
Mark the point with a solid circle or cross and label it *B*



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